Use of scrapers

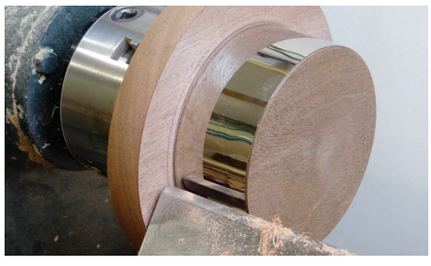
I have never been a great fan of scrapers, especially for bowl work, but I recognise they have a place, especially in end grain box making and for faceplate work, where working on the face of an item the end grain doesn't come in to play, they work very well indeed. My preference for this is for a round skew which is ground straight across – I never really got on with the round skew for its original purpose. Ground like this it becomes a negative rake scraper which can easily be rolled to around 45° when it becomes a shear scraper. It is now ideal for facing off the top of the trophy base and cutting little fillet details on the rosette, among other things.

Flattening the top of the trophy base with my negative rake shear scraper

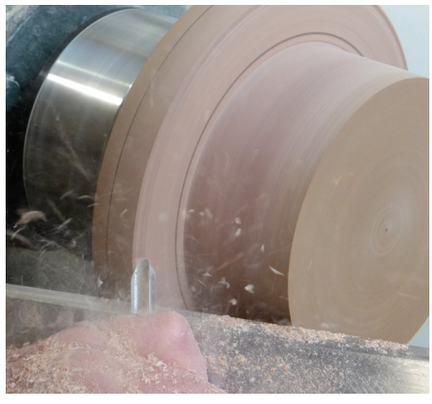
Shaping the trophy base

With the silver band fitted I just have to shape the lower detail, which is a simple curve with a small fillet or flat at each side to add definition. Here I used two variations of a draw cut and a shear cut to perfect the shape and the finish. I began by cutting just to the left of the tip to put in the initial shape, rolling it more onto its side to produce a more shear cut as the shape progressed and finishing with a shear cut, where the flute almost faces the wood and there is no bevel contact, just a razor sharp edge, presented at around 45°, to skim off the last few shavings. The fillets were then crisped up with the round scraper.

The base was then sanded 180 to 320 grit and ready for staining and oiling.

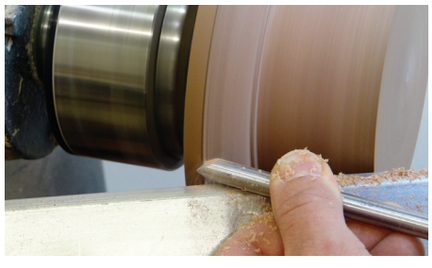


The silver band is dry fitted, which just leaves the lower edge mould to cut



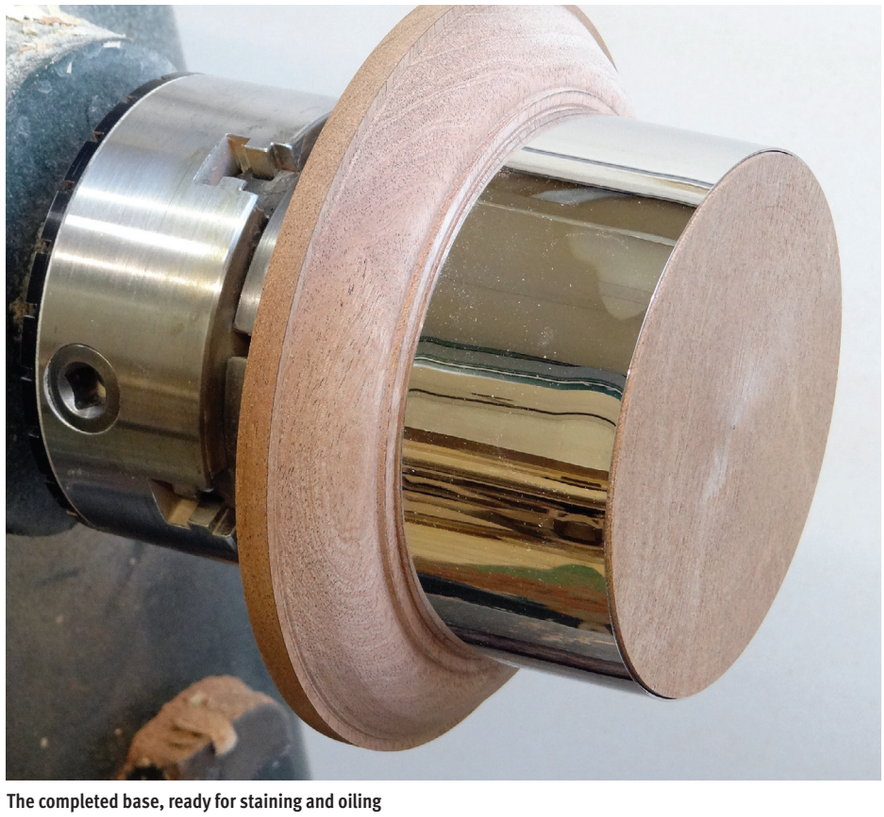
Cutting the initial shape using just to the left of the tip of the gouge

As the cut progresses I roll the tool further round to use more of the wing, making the cut more shear



The shape is finished off with a light shear cut

The base is then sanded



The completed base, ready for staining and oiling

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